

Government of India - Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation

National Sample Survey 79th Round: Operational Field Guidelines

Official Circular No. MoSPI/NSSO/SDRD/2023-79-B | Target Cadre: ISS / SSS Officers

1. Multi-Stage Stratified Sampling Architecture

A stratified two-stage design is mandated across all 36 States and Union Territories.

Rural Sector: First Stage Units (FSUs) are 2011 Census Enumeration Villages.

Urban Sector: FSUs are Urban Frame Survey (UFS) 2017-22 blocks demarcated by FOD.

Ultimate Stage Units (USUs) are systematically chosen households with equal probability.

2. Neyman Optimum Sample Allocation Strategy

Sample sizes across strata are allocated via Neyman formula: $n_h = n * (N_h * S_h) / \sum(N_i * S_i)$.

Variance is minimized under fixed survey budget by sampling high-dispersion strata more heavily.

Zero non-response bias: Mandatory callback protocols required prior to household substitution.

3. Statistical Data Quality & Audit Controls

CAPI tablet validation script verifies UPSS employment codes against weekly activity (CWS).

Outlier screening flags casual wage entries exceeding 4 sigma standard deviations from district median.

Automated geo-hash cryptographic stamp validates on-field surveyor presence.